SERMON DISCUSSION GUIDE

8 - 11 April 2026

THE CROSSROAD CHURCH

Fostering accountability - please take time to review action items if any from last weeks discussion

SERMON SUMMARY

Familiarity with the resurrection account can dull our awe. Luke invites us to step into the confusion, surprise, and joy of the first witnesses. This is not a stale story—it is living truth that still transforms lives today.

1. The Initiative of God (Luke 24:1–12)

The women came expecting death—but God had already acted. The stone was rolled away. The tomb was empty. Jesus was risen.

Key Truths:

- **God moves first — He is always the initiator in salvation.**
  - **The empty tomb confirms the finished work of Christ**
  - **The cross paid for sin**
  - **The resurrection declares our justification**
- **The resurrection was always God's plan — foretold, fulfilled, unstoppable**
- **The witnesses are credible — even when unexpected (women, doubting disciples)**
- **The resurrection is bodily and real — not symbolic, but historical and physical**

Section Summary:

God takes the initiative—raising Jesus, fulfilling His promises, and vindicating His finished work through a resurrection.

2. Four Expressions of God's Power:

- **Restoring Hope - "We had hoped…" becomes renewed hope in Christ. Jesus meets us in disappointment—not after we fix ourselves.**
- **Opening Eyes - Recognition of Jesus is a work of God. He reveals Himself—primarily through His Word.**
- **Burning Hearts - Jesus opens the Scriptures, showing that all of it points to Him. The Word ignites affection and conviction.**
- **Praising Lips - Transformed disciples become proclaiming witnesses. Encounter leads to mission.**

Section Summary:

God reveals Himself in power—restoring hope, opening eyes, igniting hearts, and sending witnesses.

3. The Life from God (Our Response)

Because Jesus is risen, we are not just informed—we are transformed.

- **United with Christ**
  - **United in His death → freed from sin**
  - **United in His resurrection → new life begins now**
  - **The Christian life is a walk—keep in step with the Spirit.**
- **Changed by Grace**
  - **Like Paul, we press on to know Christ more deeply.**
  - **The resurrection fuels ongoing transformation and pursuit.**
- **Entering God's Delight**
  - **In Luke 24, we see not only power but also the delight of God:**
  - **Jesus draws near and reveals Himself personally.**
  - **Walks with His disciples, turning weary disciples into joyful witnesses.**
  - **God delights in His people—and invites us to delight in Him.**
  - **"In your presence there is fullness of joy…" (Psalm 16:11)**

Big Idea - God who raised His Son, transforms us so that we may know Him and make Him known.

The resurrection is not just an event to believe—it is a reality that reshapes how we live.

Because Jesus is alive:

- **Hope is restored**
- **Eyes are opened**
- **Hearts are ignited**
- **Lives are empowered**

Let us respond by knowing Him deeply—and making Him known faithfully.

TAKEAWAY

See Him. Savour Him. Seek Him. Speak of Him. Everyday

QUESTIONS FOR DISCUSSION

1. **The resurrection is not just an event to believe—it is a reality that reshapes how we live.**
   a. **Encourage everyone to share how the death and resurrection of Jesus have played a transformative role in their lives,**
2. **In what ways do we see God's delight being expressed through Luke 24.**
   a. **Share practical ways in which the truth of the resurrection can fuel our transformation and growth in our daily walk?**
3. **How is your engagement with Scripture shaping your heart? What steps can you take to know Him deeply?**
   a. **The disciples' hearts burned as Jesus opened the Scriptures.**
   b. **What rhythms (or lack of rhythms) are forming your spiritual life today? What practical step can you take this week?**
4. **What would it look like for you to "make Him known" this week? What steps can you take to make Him known faithfully?**
   a. **The disciples moved from discouragement to witness.**
   b. **Who is one person you can intentionally speak to about Jesus, invite, or pray for this week?**